

'not so smart' phones

Here's what we hate about the so called smart phones of today

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The last couple of years have seen a very swift rise of the popularity of smartphones. So much so, that it is almost impossible to imagine life without them. But are they really perfect?

iOS4

About 2,30,000 iPhones are being activated on a daily basis, globally. Or so Apple claimed, back in September 2010. The annual update in 2010 saw the iPhone 4 arrive along with an updated iOS4. However, despite the hardware and software refresh, the iPhone still has its share of issues. Mind you, that has not affected its popularity one bit!



Apple iPhone4

- **Micro SIM requirement:** To work an iPhone 4, you will need to chop your existing cellular SIM card to fit the iPhone 4. Despite local johnnies gladly doing it, the problem this raises is that there is no way you can go back to using another phone without facing a hassle.
- **Signal problems remain:** The Antenna-gate literally turned into a PR disaster for Apple. The fact that they refused to acknowledge a problem with the phone and actually blamed the users for holding the phone all wrong, was precious. After offering free cases, Apple announced that it is a software issue and will be resolved soon. A couple of OS

updates later and people haven't reported serious improvement

- **Lack of expandable memory:** 16GB or 32GB- make a decision and stick with it. No expandable memory slot available.
- **Battery cannot be replaced:** The battery is sealed in. The users are not expected to access the battery. Head to the service center for any battery issues. Quite inconvenient.
- **Lack of widgets:** The iOS4 does not like Widgets. While Android is merrily showing off its widget capabilities, Apple decided the iPhone doesn't need it.
- **iTunes:** Syncing to the iPhone is a pain. Why should you 'sync'? Whatever happen to good old drag and drop?

Android

Thanks to the customisations, free applications and variety of handsets it is available on, Android is steadily on the rise. Google claims 3,00,000 Android phones are activated on a daily basis, globally. But Android too has its own problems.



HTC Legend

- **Gaming:** The Android platform has still not captured the imagination of game developers. Probably because of the non-standardised hardware, game developers find it difficult to make the games run on every phone. This is where iPhone has a definite advantage.
- **Manufacturer Customisation:** Google allows handset makers to put a skin over the OS. Example- HTC Sense. Almost every manufacturer is

doing this. Though this is designed to make the phone have additional functionality, in most cases this has an opposite effect. Software tends to crash (incompatibility, badly written software etc.), memory usage goes up and battery life comes down.

- **Poor Task Management:** Android phones have never been good at handling apps which open in the background or do not fully close upon exit. The lack of a built-in task manager created a problem which was solved by multiple third party apps. However, most people still don't use them and end up sacrificing performance and battery life.
- **Bad battery life:** The apps are to blame for this. They have a habit of being bullish when getting online updates.
- **Too many screen resolutions make it tough for app makers:** Varied screen resolutions for different devices (add tablets to that variety) and the app developers have a major task on their hands to make the apps look proper on every single screen. Some apps end up looking weird on some devices.
- **Too many Android versions:** We still have Android 1.6 on offer along with Android 2.1 and the recent update- Android 2.2 version. Which phone has which version? Quite a lot to remember when out buying a device, right?

Symbian^3

Symbian remained the way it was for a long time, a bit too long, according to most people. Symbian3 arrived in 2010, with Nokia's N8 smartphone. A lot of